

Stress Management Approaches

Organizational Behaviour — BBA, TU (3rd Semester) · Name: Your Name

A concise guide for undergraduates: what causes workplace stress, its effects, and practical ways to manage it at individual and organisational levels.

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What is Stress?

Stress is the body's natural response to pressure or challenge. In organisations it commonly stems from workload, deadlines and interpersonal demands. Not all stress is bad — **eustress** motivates and sharpens performance, while **distress** impairs health and functioning.

Eustress

Short-term, performance-enhancing — keeps employees engaged and focused.

Distress

Chronic or excessive pressure that harms physical and mental well-being.

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Common Causes of Workplace Stress

- Work overload — unrealistic deadlines and excessive tasks
- Role ambiguity — unclear expectations and responsibilities
- Role conflict — competing demands from different stakeholders
- Job insecurity — fear of layoffs or unstable contracts
- Poor working conditions — noise, ergonomics, or lack of resources

These factors often interact — e.g., ambiguous roles amplify the pressure caused by heavy workloads.

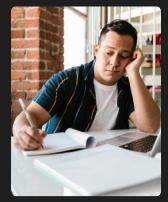
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Effects of Stress on Individuals



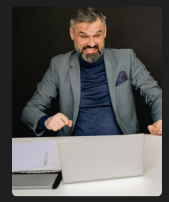
Physical

Headaches, fatigue, elevated blood pressure, sleep disruption.



Cognitive

Poor concentration, memory lapses, slower decision-making.



Emotional

Irritability, anxiety, low mood — affects relationships and performance.

Left unaddressed, these individual effects can become chronic health issues and reduce life satisfaction.

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Impact on Organisations

- Lower productivity and increased errors — stressed employees perform worse.
- Poor decision-making — cognitive load reduces judgement quality.
- Higher absenteeism and turnover — recruitment and training costs rise.
- Reduced morale and team cohesion — workplace climate suffers.

Organisational outcomes create a feedback loop: poor systems increase stress, which then further degrades performance.



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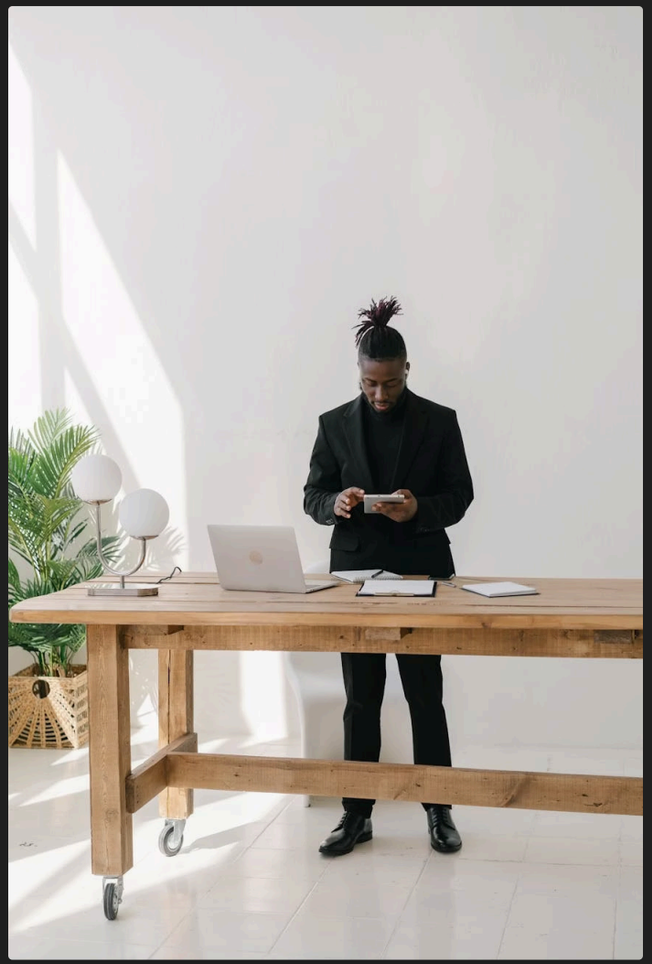
Three Approaches to Managing Stress

Effective stress management works at three levels: individual strategies, organisational interventions, and strengthening social support. Combining these produces the best outcomes for wellbeing and performance.



Integration matters — e.g., organisational training supports individual coping skills and strengthens team support networks.

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Individual Approaches — Practical Tips

Small, consistent habits compound — encourage students to build one new routine at a time.

Time Management

Prioritise tasks, set realistic deadlines, use planning tools and the Pomodoro technique.

Health Habits

Regular exercise, balanced diet, consistent sleep — foundational to resilience.

Mental Skills

Meditation, breathing exercises, positive reframing and seeking constructive feedback.

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Organisational Approaches — Design & Culture

- Job design: clarify roles, balance workload, rotate tasks to avoid monotony.
- Participative decision-making: involve employees to reduce role conflict and increase ownership.
- Training & counselling: provide stress-management workshops and access to professional help.
- Supportive leadership: leaders who communicate clearly and model healthy work habits lower stress.

Policy changes (e.g., flexible hours) combined with cultural shifts yield durable improvements.



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Social Support — The Human Safety Net

Social connections buffer stress and improve recovery. Key sources:

Encourage help-seeking and normalise conversations about stress to reduce stigma.

Family

Emotional stability, practical support outside work.

Colleagues

Peer support, workload sharing, informal problem-solving.

Professional Help

Employee assistance programmes and counselling when problems exceed peer support.

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Conclusion & Next Steps

1

Recognise

Identify sources and symptoms of stress early.

2

Respond

Apply individual techniques and seek social support.

3

Redesign

Advocate for organisational changes that reduce chronic stressors.

When individuals, teams and organisations act together, stress becomes manageable — improving health, morale and productivity.

Suggested class activity: map stressors in a current internship or part-time job and propose one individual and one organisational intervention.

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